



Best Mechanical Keyboard

TKL represent

Last year we saw most keyboards ditching cherry keys for their own proprietary versions. This year, we see more brands going for smaller form factor keyboards. TKL keyboards, ranging from 55% to 75% are all the craze. All of the keyboard nominations this year are TKL keyboards. We can certainly see the appeal: a clutter-free desk, more room for your mouse, what's not to like? Of course, just because a keyboard is smaller doesn't mean it's limited in any way. Our Digit Zero1 Award winner comes packed to the brim with features, and it's from the same brand that took the win last year.

Zero1 Award Winner and Best Buy: ASUS ROG Azoth

We're not going to lie, the ASUS ROG Azoth offered a fantastic typing and gaming experience. The keyboard comes with pre-lubed ROG NX switches. Our unit came with NX Red switches, which are linear and don't have a tactile bump. The switches offered a very polished and stable feel. Response time and actuation also felt great; again, we had zero complaints while both gaming and typing. For connectivity, you have wired, Bluetooth, and then you have the 2.4GHz ROG SpeedNova wireless technology. Here's the kicker, if you're using this keyboard with the OLED screen turned off, and the RGB lighting off, you can get a whopping 2,000+ hours of battery life on this keyboard while using 2.4GHz. 2000 hours! You could safely go months



ASUS ROG Azoth
Price: ₹22,999

without ever needing to charge the ROG Azoth. The ASUS ROG Azoth also comes with a switch lube kit inside the box. This kit includes the Krytox GPL-205-GDO lubricant, a valuable tool for users looking to venture into the realm of keyboard DIY. Lubing switches can improve their performance, reduce friction, and minimize keystroke noise. Furthermore, ASUS hasn't limited modifications to ASUS-specific parts, users who prefer MX Switches should have no compatibility issues. ASUS has even included a sort of starter tool kit for keyboard tweekers. This kit equips users with the essential tools and accessories required for keyboard modifications, switch replacements, and keycap upgrades. We've raved on enough, we're pretty sure you have a good enough idea of why the ASUS ROG Azoth is both our Digit Zero1 and Best Buy Award Winner for the mechanical keyboards category.

Runner-up: OnePlus Keyboard 81 Pro

Newcomer to the keyboard scene, OnePlus delivers a surprisingly good typing experience with its Keyboard 81 Pro. Weighing 1.87kg due to its aluminum build, it's definitely on the heavier side as far as keyboards are concerned. This does with stability during intense typing sessions, but it hampers the keyboards overall portability. The keyboard has been created in collaboration with Keychron, and you might recognise it's similarity to the Keychron Q1 Pro, which was one of its most popular models. The keyboard also comes with frills, like a volume-control knob, though its plastic material feels less premium. The cohesive colour palette, alert-slider controls, vibrant red USB cable, and crystallized dialer enhance its aesthetic and scream OnePlus. The keyboard fully supports hot-swapping; the keyboard allows easy switch replacement without soldering. With RGB at its lowest, the battery lasts over 100 hours, extending to over 200 hours when off. Overall, this is a solid debut from OnePlus and deserving of the runner up spot in the Best Mechanical Keyboards category.



OnePlus Keyboard 81 Pro
Price: ₹17,999

DIGIT BEST BUY WINNER-2023



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